A report from the Europe-based Global Public Policy Institute and the Mercator Institute for China Studies detailed the degree to which Beijing's growing political influence and intimidation tactics, combined with its economic presence, are changing how Europeans deal with China. "Political elites [in Europe] have started to embrace Chinese rhetoric and interests, including where they contradict national or European interests," wrote the report's authors.[59] After Chinese investments in Greece and the Czech Republic, for example, Athens refused to support EU condemnations of Chinese human rights abuses or its predatory South China Sea actions, while Prague turned a cold shoulder to Chinese dissidents, reversing a position taken under former president Václav Havel. The influence operation in the Czech Republic was linked to the activities of both Huawei and CEFC China Energy, which forged strong ties with Czech president Milos Zeman as well as the Czech Communist Party leader.[60] On the other side of the globe, Australian politics have been rocked in recent years by allegations of massive Chinese donations to politicians, leading to legislation to limit the influx of third-country influence operations and Chinese funds to officeholders.[61] Such "elite capture" by Beijing is a growing concern in countries around the world.

Meanwhile, China's relentless propaganda campaign is spearheaded not only by the state-controlled CCTV global television news network but by a network of over five hundred Confucius Institutes on foreign university campuses and in major cities. The Confucius Institutes are sponsored in part by a division of the Ministry of Education, the awkwardly translated "Office of Chinese Language Council International" (Hanban). Academics and administrators charge that the Confucius Institutes stifle views critical of China, particularly on college campuses, in part by threatening the withdrawal of funds for programs featuring critics of Beijing.[62] The publication of contracts between Hanban and several Australian universities revealed that the Chinese office had final say over what was taught by Confucius Institutes on those campuses as well as assessments of the teaching quality of the individual centers, seeming to confirm claims